

The other thing is to keep your project simple. If people find your project really complex to understand, they are doubtful about whether they can contribute to the code. So make your project easy to contribute to, and cut down the clutter in terms of code and ideas.

Q. Who do you look up to as inspiration?

A. Tim Berners-Lee, the creator of the Web, is my first inspiration. I keep communicating with him and sharing emails, and I do get a response once in a while. The other person is Daniel Steinberg, the author of cURL. He built that project, which is installed on every computer in the world. So that is something that is very inspiring. He is very transparent and shares his experiences on his blog. I seek advice from him, and I think he is among the best persons to follow in the open source world.

I would encourage everyone to attend events, as that is where we can come across the achievers in the open source industry. That really helps to build your network and push projects forward.

Q. Any nervousness during your open source journey, and how did you overcome it?

A. Oh, yes! That happens almost every once or twice a year and it's absolutely fine to accept those situations. I had to shut down my startup when I realised it was not working out. That was really difficult, but it kept me pushing to think about what exactly I wanted to do.

I moved on to working with Jina. I now understand that one need not go by the trends out there, but rather be more focused on what you really want to do for the long term. We have a huge community of 15K ML engineers at Jina now.

Q. What's your message to all the developers out there?

A. I think people should be more aware of open source as I can see a rapid transformation in the industry. I strongly believe that any software that is proprietary right now will soon have an open source alternative — if not this year, then maybe in just a couple of years. I foresee a future built on open source.

If you are a developer, this is the time to think about open source and the ways in which you can contribute to it and be more involved in that space. Just keep learning and build projects. And the bigger question to address now is building sustainable open source projects. There is a sweet spot for developers to build open source software in a transparent manner and make it sustainable by producing a software as a service (SaaS) version of it. For those who do not want to go through the struggle of maintaining software, SaaS could be the best solution. This may be a bit early to state, but I am pretty confident that most of the projects we see in open source will really move to this kind of model to make it sustainable. And that's the future — SaaS plus open source.

Q. Are you planning any expansion and what are the skills you are looking for?

A. At Jina AI, we are currently hiring for engineering roles. For my team, I am looking for people with technical writing, community development and event management skills **END** 

OSFY Magazine Attractions During 2022-23

Month	Theme
March 2022	Security, Network Management and Monitoring
April 2022	Open Source Programming (Languages and tools)
May 2022	DevOps Special
June 2022	AI, Deep learning and Machine Learning
July 2022	Database management and Optimisation
August 2022	Cloud Special: Everything from management to implementation
September 2022	Mobile/Web App Development, Optimisation and Security
October 2022	Blockchain and Open Source
November 2022	Open Source and IoT and Edge
December 2022	Data science, Data security, Data Management, Storage and Backup
January 2023	Docker and containers
February 2023	Open Source on Windows and Best in the world of Open Source (Tools and Services)